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Executive summary

The Okanagan Housing Co-op (OKHC) is facing several challenges such as- public awareness, misconceptions of what housing co-ops are and difficulty in attracting members that align with the co-op's values. In response, this report presents a cost-effective, research-intensive marketing strategy tailored to OKHC's specific financial and operational constraints. Using a mix of primary research (site visits, board meetings, and a member survey) and secondary research (competitor benchmarking, website audit, and marketing best practices), our team identified key opportunities that would enhance OKHC's community reach. The survey revealed the value and pain points of OKHC from existing members that we've used to guide our recommendations. Our deliverables consist of four amalgamated initiatives: 1) the creation of an Instagram Business Profile to raise awareness; (2) improvements to OKHC's website and Google Business Profile to increase visibility and trust; (3) participation in Kelownas Farmers & Crafters Market as a non-profit with the support of print marketing materials such as banners, flyers, and business cards; and (4) the development of an formattable fact sheet to extend to local governing bodies. Each initiative is partnered by specific KPIs, a cost analysis and a weekly implementation timeline. We examined potential risks, including financial capital, digital literacy barriers and time constraints amongst members. Our mitigation strategies include prioritizing low-cost tools, disabling Instagram comments, and sourcing free digital marketing training courses. The proposed plug-and-play marketing approach is designed to support OKHC in creating long-term awareness, defining their value proposition and attracting value-aligned members, strengthening their position in the Central Okanagan housing industry to address the housing crisis.

Problem Statement

OKHC is currently struggling with public awareness in the region, misconceptions about what a housing co-op is, and attracting value-matched prospects. Our team has been tasked with creating a feasible marketing campaign for the constraints OKHC operates within and solving the issues they face today.

Research Methodology

Our team conducted various research methodologies, including primary and secondary data collection and comprehensive analysis of the data in a SWOT and competitor analysis. This research helped guide our recommendations for OKHC's marketing plan, which are outlined below.

Primary Research

Site Visit

Our team conducted a site visit early in the semester to view the housing co-op and learn more about the culture and community that OKHC has. This site visit was extremely valuable in providing us with information regarding OKHC's plans for development within the housing co-op, how/where they host events, how interconnected their community space is, the numerous amenities available and emphasized the property's major selling points to members. This data aided us in creating marketing copy that appeals to the correct type of value-matched candidates that OKHC is attempting to capture and guided the recommendations for which local representatives OKHC should be in contact for community planning initiatives and housing development proposals.

Board Meeting

Our team was invited by the OKHC board to come and ask any questions or present any ideas to them. This meeting was highly beneficial for us in understanding the problems that OKHC faces today and what they are looking for us to help them resolve. This meeting allowed us to truly understand the issues they face and the constraints they have faced thus far in previous efforts. This information provided a comprehensive view of the problem statement, and the open dialogue allowed us to understand what types of recommendations would benefit them and what

would not be feasible for them to maintain. The meeting also allowed us to understand better how the board operates and guided us in the early parts of our proposal.

Survey

To better understand the key components that attract individuals to the co-op, we surveyed willing members of OKHC. The goal of this survey was to gather insights on how members perceive the co-op, their level of participation, and what factors influence their satisfaction and involvement. Through the collected data, we learned that currently, the average length of membership within the co-op is 15 years; most survey participants initially heard about the co-op through word of mouth from friends and members. Roughly 74% of respondents enjoy or strongly enjoy their experience within the co-op, with key motivators being affordability, community living, and housing security. 77% of the respondents are between 35 – 64 years of age and primarily use Facebook and Instagram as their primary social media platforms. The main barrier to increased participation within the co-op is time constraints resulting from work or family responsibilities. By analyzing member demographics, social media usage, and key motivations, we tailored the marketing strategy to reinforce what is currently working, adopting a digital marketing campaign using a social media platform that members are familiar with, highlighting the strengths and attractive features of the co-op, also ensuring the strategy can be managed with the current time constraints of OKHC members.

Secondary Research

Benefits of Having a Well-Designed Website

According to WebFX (2025), some of the components of a well-designed website include:

- Digital Storefront for Your Business:
 - A well-designed website serves as a digital storefront where potential customers can learn about your business, products, and services.
- Enhanced User Engagement:
 - Attractive design elements like images, videos, and appealing colour schemes increase user engagement.
 - A good design ensures easy navigation, which is a top priority for 94% of online users.

- Credibility and Trust:
 - Poor design or layout can lead to 94% of users mistrusting or rejecting a website.
- Improved User Experience:
 - Features like intuitive navigation, fast page loading times, and mobile-friendliness improve the user experience, keeping visitors engaged.
 - 42% of people leave websites with poor functionality.

Benchmarking Competitor Websites Against OKHC

The evaluation of competitors' websites is necessary to understand how the company has displayed the digital storefront of their business. This included an analysis of the Okanagan region's direct competitors and some Lower Mainland co-ops. Their websites were reviewed to identify strengths or common elements that could be adapted to the current OKHC website.

It can be highlighted that some of the strengths of their websites can be compared with the content found under “Benefits of having a well-designed website.” Some key aspects considered include simple navigation, a gallery (including photos of the units and community events and spaces), and a straightforward contact method where people can write their questions and send the message directly to the organization. Furthermore, there are considerations for a section showcasing the people in power of the co-op and a more professional design rather than the simplified look OKHC currently has.

How to Improve a Website?

We researched to better understand how to improve website design to aid us while conducting the website Mock-up for OKHC. According to WebFX (2025) and WebFX (N.D), some of the key considerations when trying to improve a website include:

- Consistent Branding: maintaining brand and industry alignment for credibility.
 - Use a style guide covering colours, target audience, voice, and messaging.
 - Ensure a unified brand experience across all dealer platforms.
- Prioritize readability and appealing visuals to enhance user experience.
 - Use clear headings, readable fonts, and high-contrast colours for readability.
- Optimize websites to rank higher in search results
 - Search engine optimization (SEO)

- Use targeted keywords relevant to the business.
- Simplify Main Navigation
 - Design navigation based on what users need to find quickly.
- Optimize Multimedia
 - Use images and videos to engage visitors.
- Ensure mobile-friendliness
 - Use responsive design to ensure seamless viewing across all devices.
 - Mobile traffic accounts for over 59% of global website traffic.
- Make the site inclusive for disabled users by:
 - Adding image alt text and video captions, video transcripts, and a keyboard-friendly navigation
- Including a community calendar
 - Upcoming events

Website Audit

An audit of OKHC's website highlights key aspects of its overall visibility, user experience, and content presentation. The website benefits from having its domain (www.okhc.ca), enhancing credibility and discoverability on Google search results (SERP). Additionally, the comprehensive FAQs section provides clear and detailed responses to common inquiries, making the information easily accessible to visitors. The SEO strategy is fairly effective, with the site ranking high or first result for search terms such as "housing co-operative," "co-op housing," and "co-op housing near me." However, there is an opportunity to expand visibility by incorporating broader keywords like "affordable housing near me" and other related search terms that are also location-optimized organically.

Despite these strengths, the website lacks visual appeal, as it does not feature images of housing units, model homes, the broader co-op community and infographics. This absence of visuals makes it less engaging for potential members seeking insight into the living environment and community. The content is also text-heavy and leans toward formal, institutional language rather than customer-friendly communication, which may reduce readability and deter potential members. While the application form and redirect function are valuable features that streamline the membership application process, the Contact Us page appears incomplete, and faces, names,

or personalized details that could enhance trust and engagement are missing. Additionally, there is no clear call to action (CTA) directing visitors toward the following steps, such as applying or learning more about the Co-op.

Components of a Successful Google Business Profile

We also researched the necessary components to have a successful Google business profile. According to WebFX (2019), some of the key components include:

- The listing includes name, rating, reviews, address, photos, and website.
- The customer visits the business, leading to a successful conversion.
- Proximity: The closer the business is to the searcher, the higher it ranks.
- Customer Reviews: More positive reviews improve credibility and ranking.
- Keeping information accurate and updated is crucial.

Research on Print Marketing Tools

Incorporating marketing tools such as *business cards*, *flyers*, and *banners* as an event strategy can significantly enhance OKHC's brand presence and effectiveness in engaging with the target audience.

Benefits of Print Marketing:

- Establish a Brand Identity: By consistently using OKHC's colours, font, and messaging across all print materials, the co-op can create a cohesive brand experience and a better impression on potential members (Lange, 2023).
- Reach New Audience: While digital channels effectively reach a broad audience quickly, print materials ensure that OKHC can reach people not as engaged online, especially within the local community events (Lange, 2023).
- Build Credibility and Trust: Nowadays, misinformation, scams, and fake news are common; print materials provide a tangible and professional way to educate people about OKHC, its values as a co-op, and its success stories (Alphagraphics, 2024).
- Provide Information in a Convenient Format: All print marketing materials show an overview of what OKHC offers and allow attendees or interesting people to reference at their convenience (Alphagraphics, 2024).

Business Cards

Despite the digital age, business cards remain an essential tool for personal networking. They can help OKHC's representatives establish a stronger personal connection in events and meetings. Benefits:

- Facilitating Personal Connections: Exchanging business cards fosters face-to-face interactions and can lead to more meaningful interactions (Badmus, 2024).
- Reflecting Brand Identity: A well-designed business card serves as a representation of the co-op's brand and professionalism (Badmus, 2024).
- Convenience and Professionalism: They provide a quick and efficient way to share contact information, making networking smoother (Badmus, 2024).

Flyers

They are an effective tool for sharing detailed information about what OKHC is and its benefits as a co-op and attracting future members aligned with the OKHC's values. Benefits:

- Tangible and Memorable: Tangible materials tend to generate a positive memory association, making the OKHC marketing message stick more effectively (Davis, 2020).
- Easy to Distribute: Their versatility allows us to reach a broad audience in multiple locations. Precision in flyer distribution, like in local events, enhances OKHC's ability to connect with the right audience (Davis, 2020).
- Highly Customizable: The flexibility of the design allows OKHC to adapt the marketing tool to communicate what the co-op wants or needs to promote according to the event (Davis, 2020).

Banners

At events, banners are an essential instrument that immediately communicates OKHC's presence and mission, capturing attention and reinforcing brand recognition and credibility.

Benefits:

- Enhance the Event Atmosphere: Banners create an inviting, immersive environment reflecting the brand's identity (n.d., 2024).
- Capture Customers' Attention: Well-designed banners attract attendees to the stand, facilitating initial engagement (n.d., 2024).
- Facilitate Targeted Messaging: OKHC can use banners with clear and compelling messages that directly speak to the interests and needs of the target audience (n.d., 2024).

Incorporating marketing tools such as business cards, flyers, and banners during events can be a great strategy, significantly enhancing OKHC's brand presence and effectiveness in engaging with the target audience. The decision to use these tools is not only because they tend to be more affordable than other merchandise that companies often use during events, like pens, key holders, sunglasses, or tote bags, making them a better fit for OKHC's budget constraints, but also because, while they may not be as interactive, they effectively communicate key information concisely and engagingly.

Survey Layout

We researched the most effective survey strategies and tactics to increase survey participation. A recurring theme in this research was the use of cognitive dissonance and how reducing dissonance is a primary factor in one's decision to respond (Carpenter, 2024). Using this information, we constructed an introduction question asking for participation and highlighting the confidentiality of the survey. We learned that people are most likely to participate in a survey delivered to them by someone they know. We were able to meet with the board before the survey was sent out and have a member of the co-op send the survey out to everyone. Conducting surveys has numerous benefits; it is one of the cheapest and fastest ways of gathering information and opinions from a group of people. For our context, conducting the survey and asking specific questions about the co-op provided us with key insights into what areas of the co-op's current marketing work, along with which components and values attract members to OKHC. The survey questions also gave us member testimonials to be featured in our final deliverables. Our research into effective web design found overwhelming suggestions for including testimonials. Displaying testimonials is a key factor in building trust on the website; testimonials allow the reader to make a personal connection with the company (Nargi-Ackerbauer, 2024). With the nature of the business being rooted in the community, it was obvious we needed to create a connection with visitors to the website.

Analysis of Data

SWOT Analysis



A comprehensive SWOT analysis played a crucial role in our findings, providing deeper insight into the co-op's structure and the effectiveness of its business model. While operating as a non-profit, the co-op has distinct strengths and challenges, along with valuable opportunities to capitalize on while strategically mitigating potential threats.

Competitor Analysis

	Management Model	Housing Types	Target Demographic	Member Involvement	Equity Share Requirement	Location Accessibility	Marketing Presence
OKHC	CHF BC Co-op	Townhouses	Families Professionals Diverse groups	Yes	Yes	High	Limited lacks detailed website and active social media channels.
Providence Ridge	Non-Profit	Apartment Townhouses	Individuals seniors families	No	No	High	Operated by the Society of Hope- informative website detailing properties and services.
COCHA	CHF BC Co-op	Apartments Townhouses Bungalows	Seniors (55+)	Yes	Yes	High	Comprehensive website with detailed information about properties and application processes.
CCHS	Non-Profit	Apartment Townhouses	Low-to-moderate-income individuals	No	No	High	Comprehensive website with detailed information about properties and application processes.
Southgate Manor	CHF BC Co-op	N/A	N/A	Yes	N/A	Moderate	No website or social media presence

The competitor analysis would show that, while OKHC does not have direct competitors as a co-op housing provider, it does face competition in the overall housing marketing, specifically subsidized non-profit housing.

Recommendations and Analysis

Our recommendations can be broken down into four separate initiatives, including a social media campaign on Instagram, website improvements and Google profile enhancement, attendance of local events with a print marketing development and price breakdown, and creation of an editable factsheet to be going out to local representatives. See Figure A.1 in Appendix A for a breakdown of the scope of each deliverable.

Social Media Implementation

Our recommendation is for OKHC to implement one business account on Instagram. This decision comes from primary research from speaking to the board, secondary research into the benefits of implementing a social media account for a housing co-op, and consideration of OKHC's constraints.

Our primary research indicated that a key consideration when implementing a social media campaign is ensuring that we select the correct platform (Forbes Agency Council, 2019). Using the correct platform ensures that OKHC is reaching the target audience they are attempting to reach. To better understand which platform OKHC members use, we included this question in our survey. OKHC members utilized Facebook and Instagram evenly; however, considering OKHC's past attempts to run a Facebook group, which did not have the intended success, we have narrowed our recommendation to include solely an Instagram business account. A business account will allow OKHC to track insights, support paid advertising, and turn off comments and DMs to discourage member conflict (Kuligowski, 2025). Some of the other key considerations when creating a social media account include testing engagement with numerous forms of content, such as videos showing community events, posting educational material on what housing co-ops are, and explaining how OKHC is the “missing middle” and the gold standard of housing co-ops (Hajji, 2024).

Having a social media presence can help OKHC build their awareness within the community, offering a way to show the community who OKHC is and what sets it apart from other housing options in the region (Hajji, 2024). OKHC provides a unique value prop occupying

a space that is rarely considered; implementing an Instagram account would allow community members to see how OKHC operates, learn what a housing co-op is, and how OKHC could be the right fit for them or someone they know. Building brand recognition in the minds of community members helps attract the value-matched candidates they are searching for, alleviates misconceptions of what housing co-ops are, and informs the community of their existence, all issues outlined in the constraints that OKHC faces today. An Instagram account is a cost-effective, low-effort marketing tactic that can offer OKHC value by engaging with potential new members and the surrounding community, creating connections and trust, and redefining what housing co-ops look like (Zingg, 2024). Through our research into successful campaigns, our team found extreme value creation by sharing testimonials from members of the housing co-op, which were obtained through our survey administration (BuzzBoard, 2024). Testimonials help reinforce OKHC's key values, build credibility, and build a story in which the correct prospects can envision themselves.

A balanced Instagram strategy with organic content or paid advertising will maximize OKHC's visibility, engagement, and lead generation. OKHC should maintain an organic posting schedule at least once weekly, focusing on community highlights, member testimonials, educational posts, and FAQs to engage potential members. Posts made during the week should be scheduled to go out from 9 am to 11 am to maximize engagement (Lang, 2026). Stories and reels should be used to boost interaction, and hashtags/geolocation tags will improve discoverability. A clear, optimized bio with a website link and branded visuals will further enhance credibility (Constant Contact, 2024). A mock Instagram profile can be found in Appendix A Figure A.2. Mock posts can be found in Appendix A from Figures A.3 to A.10. A list of KPIs for this initiative can be found in Appendix A Figure A.11.

Organic vs Paid Ads

For paid advertising, a \$100–\$300 monthly budget should be allocated to:

- Awareness Ads – Educating the public on co-op housing.
- Engagement Ads – Encouraging interaction and trust.
- Lead Generation Ads – Driving applications through targeted promotions.

Paid Ad Targeting:

- Demographics: Ages 35-64, seeking affordable housing in Kelowna.

- Best Timing: Ads should run at the end of the month when people are actively searching for housing.

Paid Ad KPIs:

- Click-Through Rate (CTR) – How many users interact with the ads.
- Conversion Rate – Applications submitted after clicking an ad.
- Cost Per Click (CPC) – Tracking ad spend efficiency.

To implement this strategy effectively, OKHC should establish an Instagram Business Profile, build organic engagement, and then gradually introduce paid ads based on performance insights. This approach will increase awareness, attract value-matched candidates, and streamline the membership process efficiently.

Website Improvement

Instead of doing a complete redesign, we focused on keeping the strongest elements of the existing website while improving specific sections and adding new functionalities. OKHC's website was redesigned to improve the organization's digital presence, strengthen credibility and trust, and optimize the user experience. To achieve this, we considered key findings from secondary research, such as the best practices for website improvement. Also, we incorporated insights from competitor analysis and benchmarking competitor websites against OKHC.

Key Improvements

1. Homepage & Navigation

As can be seen in Figure A.12 in Appendix A, we added a home landing page, which the previous version lacked. Before, users would land directly on a block of text. Now, there's a more engaging introduction with direct access to the co-op application, key visuals, and a simplified navigation menu that makes it easier to find all sections.

2. What is a Housing Co-op?

This section mainly remained unchanged since it provided relevant information from the Co-operative Housing Federation of BC (Figure A.13 in Appendix A).

3. About OKHC

As shown in Figure A.14 in Appendix A, we restructured this section to clearly explain how the co-op works, its mission, vision, and values, which are now presented more interactively, and a detailed location description was added.

4. New Section: Testimonials and Statistics

A testimonials section was introduced to showcase the real experiences of co-op members. In Figure A.15 in Appendix A, testimonials can be seen, which were gathered through interviews and presented in short quotes alongside photos or video clips where members talk about their experience living in the co-op. We also added relevant statistics that would boost credibility.

5. How to Apply?

The application process was streamlined into three simple steps, making it easier to understand. A direct link to the application form was added to simplify the process (Figure A.16 in Appendix A).

6. New Section: Gallery

As can be seen in Figure A.17 in Appendix A, a photo gallery was added. It's divided into three sections:

- Units: Showcasing the apartments and their layouts.
- Community Spaces: Highlighting shared spaces, green areas, and common facilities.
- Events: Featuring annual community events such as Halloween celebrations.

7. Contact Us

As shown in Figure A.18 in Appendix A, this section was significantly improved by adding a contact form where users can enter their name, email, phone number, and inquiries sent directly to the co-op's general email. Additionally, we included photos and names of key board members to make the organization feel more transparent and approachable.

8. FAQs

The FAQ section was redesigned to replace a long text block with an interactive menu. Now, users can click on questions to expand the answers, making it more user-friendly (Figure A.19 in Appendix A).

9. Internal Page: Condo Control

The Condo Control page, the operational system used by OKHC members, was maintained to ensure easy access (Figure A.20 in Appendix A).

Google Business Profile Improvements

OKHC must emphasize adding important missing information such as a phone number to make reaching out easier for potential applicants, the business hours to inform when inquiries can be answered, a short description explaining the history/mission, and add the business category.

Furthermore, to increase engagement and credibility, OKHC can request reviews from current or past members, focusing on their experiences. Also, in case of receiving inquiries, it is necessary to be proactive and answer them quickly. Add a primary picture of the official logo and other images showing common areas to reinforce the branding.

Fact Sheet Development

To spread awareness among local government officials, we researched local representatives who should be aware of the Okanagan Housing Co-op. We constructed a list of contact information for Kelowna and West Kelowna city council members, as well as local MLAs and community planners, which is in Appendix A Figure A.22. We've also developed an editable PDF to be sent out to these contacts meant to be updated as changes to OKHC occur which can be found in Appendix A Figure A.21. The document touches on the current housing crisis in the Okanagan and highlights how housing co-ops are the missing middle and a solution that requires their attention and support. To track the progress and effectiveness of the fact sheet, we have established a goal of a 30% response rate, excluding automated emails.

Attending Local Events

We recommend that OKHC begin attending local events in the community to help bring further awareness of their existence through word of mouth and flyers. By attending local farmers' markets and paid events, OKHC can increase their brand interaction and gain access to a larger audience (Behbehani, 2022). The research in this section outlines the registration process and requirements, the benefits of doing so, as well as the price breakdown for physical marketing material and their respective design mock-ups. Attending farmer's markets can be a low-cost, low-effort marketing channel that offers the community face-to-face interactions with real co-op members, helping build trust (Admin, 2025). This can help engage the community with OKHC's initiatives and increase their brand awareness (Behbehani, 2022). This also offers OKHC the

ability to connect with those who may not have access to social media or who would prefer to ask questions in person. Our team believes this option operated within the bandwidth constraints OKHC has outlined. This initiative is low-risk for members and requires around 4-6 hours once a week in the form of set-up and attendance.

OKHC can apply when the Kelowna Farmers' & Crafters Market Society opens applications at the beginning of March. OKHC will register as a non-profit and provide general information regarding OKHC using the form found in Appendix A, Figure A.23. After approval, KFCMS will offer a free stall to nonprofits on Wednesday market day and allow for flyers, infographics, stickers, and brochures to be handed out. Our team has designed the business card (Figures A.24 and A.25 in Appendix A), flyer (Figures A.26 and A.27 in Appendix A), and banner (Figure A.28 in Appendix A). We have provided a cost breakdown below. A KPI chart regarding attendance and lead generation can be found in Appendix A, Figure A.30.

Price breakdown

Before presenting the pricing details of each tool, it is essential to refer to Figure A.29 in Appendix A, where the complete quotation is provided.

Business Cards

OKHC's business cards are advantageous because they are black and white, given the colours of the co-op logo. This reduces printing costs compared to colour prints, making them more cost-effective.

- 100 units → \$46.50 (\$0.47 each)
- 250 units → \$62.00 (\$0.25 each)
- 500 units → \$82.50 (\$0.17 each)
- 1000 units → \$112 (\$0.12 each)

Given the quantity and quality of the material, the pricing is highly affordable. While printing 1000 cards may not sound reasonable, ordering 500 for \$82.50 can be an option. This will allow, for example, the five key members of the Board of Directors to have 100 business cards each.

Flyers

A colour flyer was chosen because it is more visually engaging and has a more substantial impact. The selected paper is of moderate quality. It is not the highest-end option, but it is still good enough to maintain professionalism.

- 100 units → \$112.00 (\$1.12 each)
- 150 units → \$142.80 (\$0.95 each)
- 250 units → \$153.16 (\$0.61 each)
- 500 units → \$252.00 (\$0.50 each)
- 1000 units → \$409.00 (\$0.40 each)

It is still a reasonable investment, considering OKHC can participate in events with at least two or three flyers sharing different information about the co-op. For example, one option can be printing 500 flyers for \$252, allowing OKHC to produce two versions, with around 250 copies each. Another option would be to have three versions, resulting in about 165 copies per design. This should be enough for two, maybe three, busy events.

Banner

Finally, the banner includes both the printed display and the metal stand. This is a large, high-quality banner, approximately 2 meters by 90 centimetres, printed in full colour.

- Final cost: \$274 - \$300

Although this is a higher upfront investment, it is cost-efficient in the long run. Unlike flyers or business cards, which are cheaper but must be constantly restocked, a banner is a one-time purchase that can be reused for multiple events.

Paid Event (Optional):

In conjunction with attending local farmers markets, our team discovered the Housing Central conference: BC's Affordable Housing Conference in Vancouver, BC, from November 17-18, 2025. BC's Affordable Housing conference partners with the Co-operative Housing Federation to introduce keynote speakers, educational sessions and special events to share knowledge, ideas and inspiration within this housing sector. This paid conference aims to connect local representatives with BC's affordable housing sector and inform them of how OKHC helps support the non-profit housing sector in BC. This would help increase OKHC's visibility within the province and build relationships with community leaders.

A yearly budget that OKHC would want to consider for the implementation of moderate paid options would be \$1500 annually. This would include 500 business cards, 500 flyers, 1 banner, 2 paid ads per quarter and attending the paid conference for one day. A full price breakdown for multiple options can be found in Appendix B, Figure 3.

Action Plan + Timeline

The action plan is a week-by-week breakdown per month of the implementation and upkeep of the marketing strategy (see Appendix B, Figure B.1). The initial changes to be made take place in week i and week ii; these changes include creating an Instagram account, reworking the current website, reworking the Google Business profile, creating marketing materials such as business cards, flyer and banner, sourcing a vendor for the marketing materials, and applying for the farmer's market. The estimated time for completing these tasks is around ten and a half hours. We have split this into two separate weeks to accommodate a limited schedule.

The next four weeks of the marketing plan should be repeated after completing weeks 4, 8, 16, etc. Week 1 consists of sending out the provided fact sheet to the contacts in the local representative list and posting it to the Instagram page. Week 2 will be posting to Instagram and attending the farmers market for approximately three hours. Week 3 is only a post to Instagram. Week 4 consists of posting to Instagram and attending the farmer's market. Week 5,6,7,8... will recycle the same schedule as weeks 1-4. As the time requirement significantly increases in weeks, requiring attendance at the farmers' market, we recommend having a team of at least 2 people.

Every 12 weeks, we encourage the team to reevaluate the digital marketing materials and make necessary changes. To come up with the time requirements, we tracked our progress while creating the mock-ups and added time in areas we had previous experience; it is essential to note that these numbers are averages and as the team repeats these skills, their time requirement should go down. The breakdown of each item can be found in Appendix B, Figure B.2.

Risks and Mitigation Strategies

When implementing the marketing plan, there are a few risks that could impact progress or jeopardize the success of the strategy. The first one is budget constraints. We understand that for this plan to be successful, it needs to be low cost; that is why we are prioritizing cheap and free avenues both online through Instagram and the existing website, as well as in person at the

Kelowna Farmers Market. We also recognize that OKHC has had issues in the past with negative comments and messaging on social media platforms. To mitigate this, we recommend disabling comments on the Instagram account so that individuals cannot spread negativity through the posts. The subsequent potential risk is in digital literacy, as the individual running the campaign may need to have some knowledge of technological platforms. To mitigate this, we found free online courses that focus on educating digital marketing; these courses are offered through Google Digital Garage and Coursera, as well as through the BC Affordable Housing site. Another risk that we found is time constraints. From survey feedback and consistent meetings, we understand many members have limited time to contribute. To mitigate this risk, we have put together a direct week-by-week action plan complete with a timeline for individual tasks to ensure the campaign can be implemented with a minimal hourly requirement.

Conclusion

Our team created a plug-and-play marketing campaign for OKHC to help solve their issues of struggling with public awareness in the region, and misconceptions about what housing co-ops are attractive value-matched prospects. We conducted extensive primary and secondary research, including visiting the board and site, survey administration, benchmarking OKHC's website against competitors, a website audit, necessary components for print marketing, a SWOT analysis and competitor analysis. This research helped us develop four comprehensive recommendations, including an Instagram account, website re-design, and Google business profile, the development of a fact sheet and local representatives and attendance at local events, both paid and free. Each recommendation supports solving a different issue from OKHC's problem statement and aligns with the constraints that OKHC operates within, such as budget and time constraints and finding co-op members to fill the role. We have outlined the potential risks and mediation strategies and a timeline breakdown for the members who will be managing the campaigns. We have equipped OKHC with the necessary tools in our report and findings to help them establish a well-managed marketing campaign that our team is confident will help solve the problems they face today.

Appendix A

Figure A.1 - Scope breakdown of final deliverables

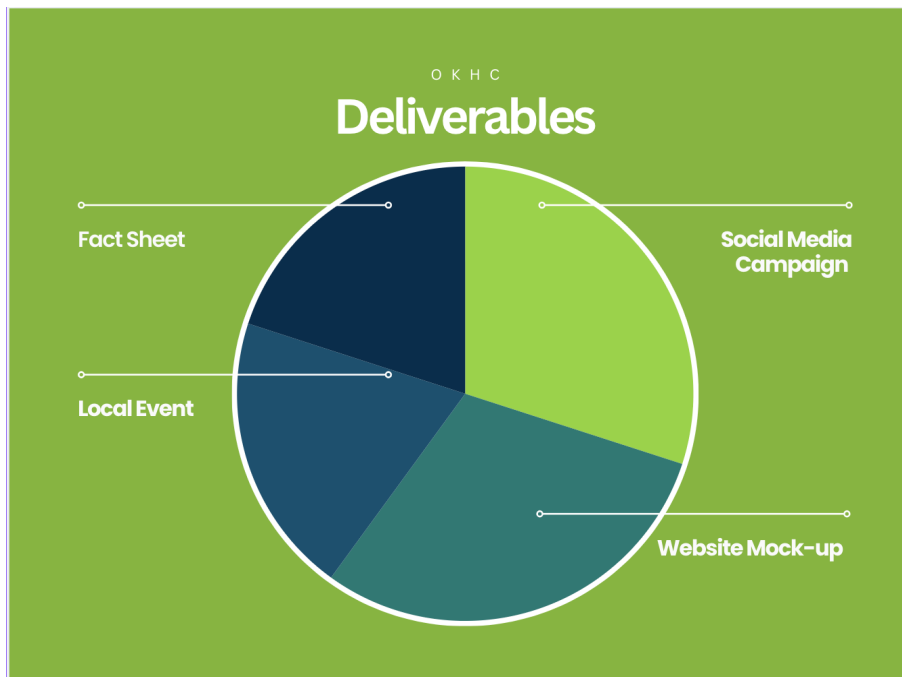


Figure A.2 - Mock Business Instagram Profile

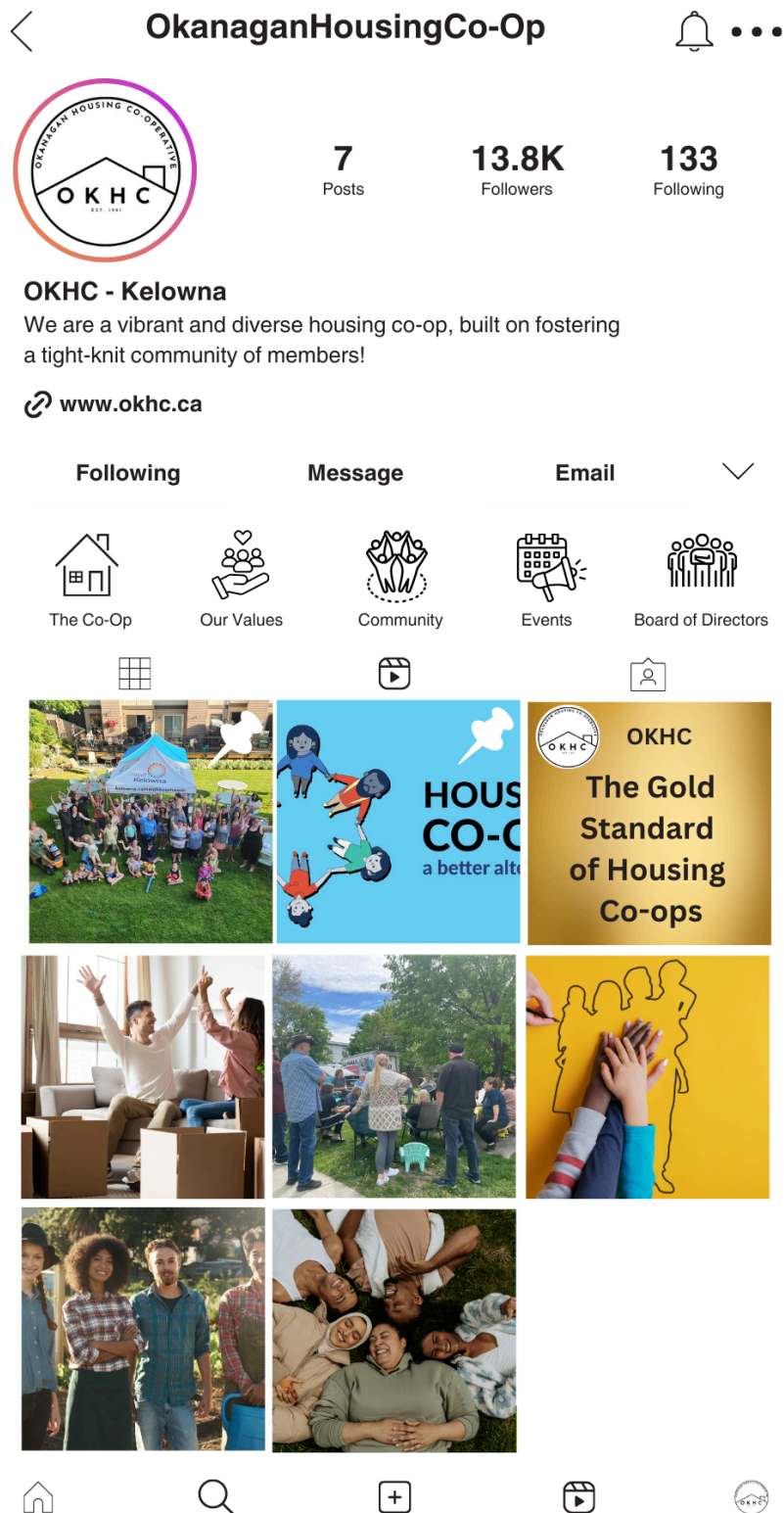


Figure A.3 - Mock Post #1



Figure A.4 - Mock Post #2



Figure A.5 - Mock Post #3



Figure A.6 - Mock Post #4

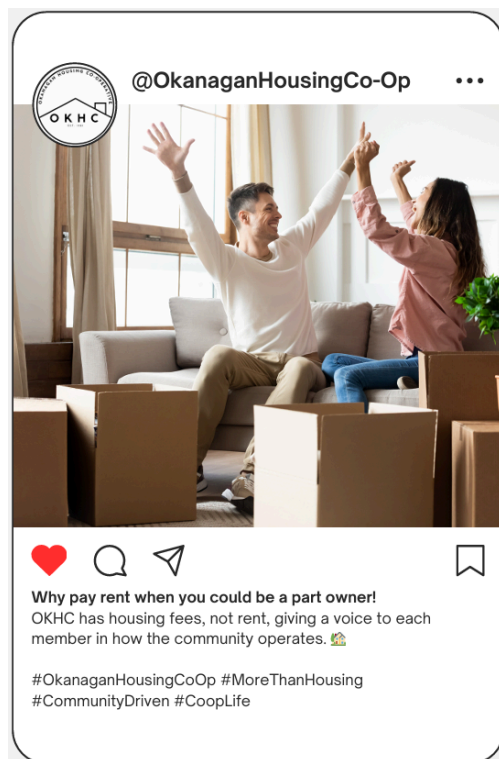


Figure A.7 - Mock Post #5



Figure A.8 - Mock Post #6



Figure A.9 - Mock Post #7



Figure A.10 - Mock Post #8



Figure A.11 - Organic KPIs for the Instagram account:

Organic KPIs:

- Follower Growth – Gradual increase in engaged followers.
- Engagement Rate – Gradual increase over time of likes, comments, shares.
- Direct Messages & Leads – At least 3 inquiries per month via Instagram.
- Link Clicks – Increase in application page visits to 2 per month.

Figure A.12 - Website Mock-up: Front Page

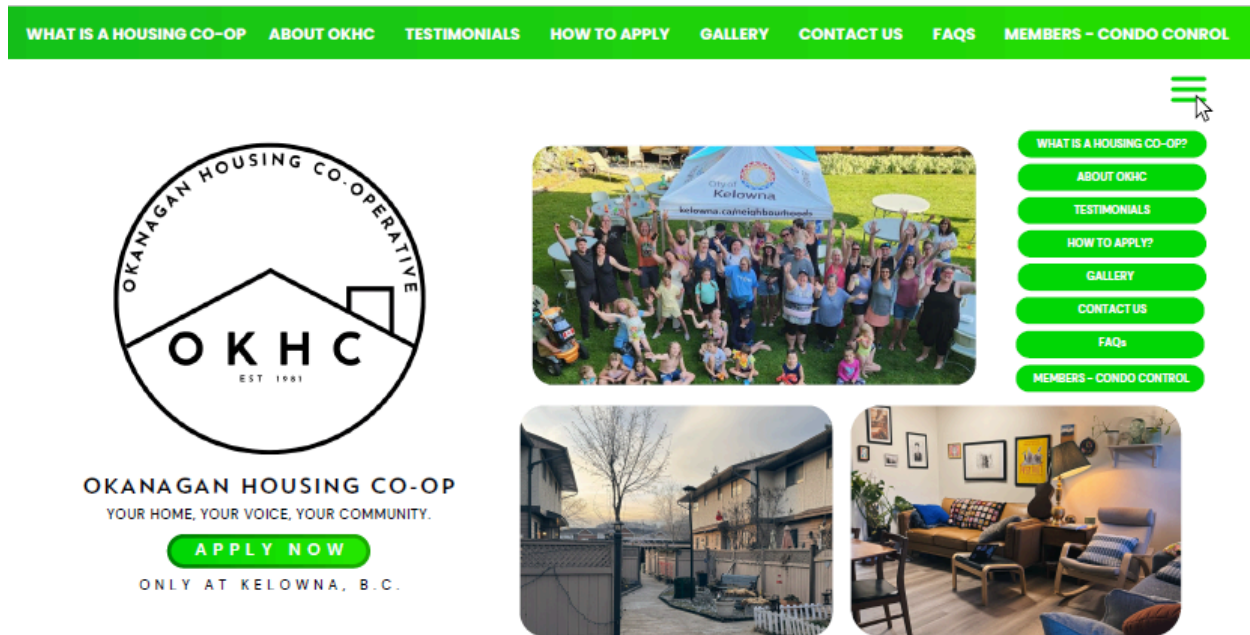


Figure A.13 - Website Mock-up: What is a Housing Co-op?

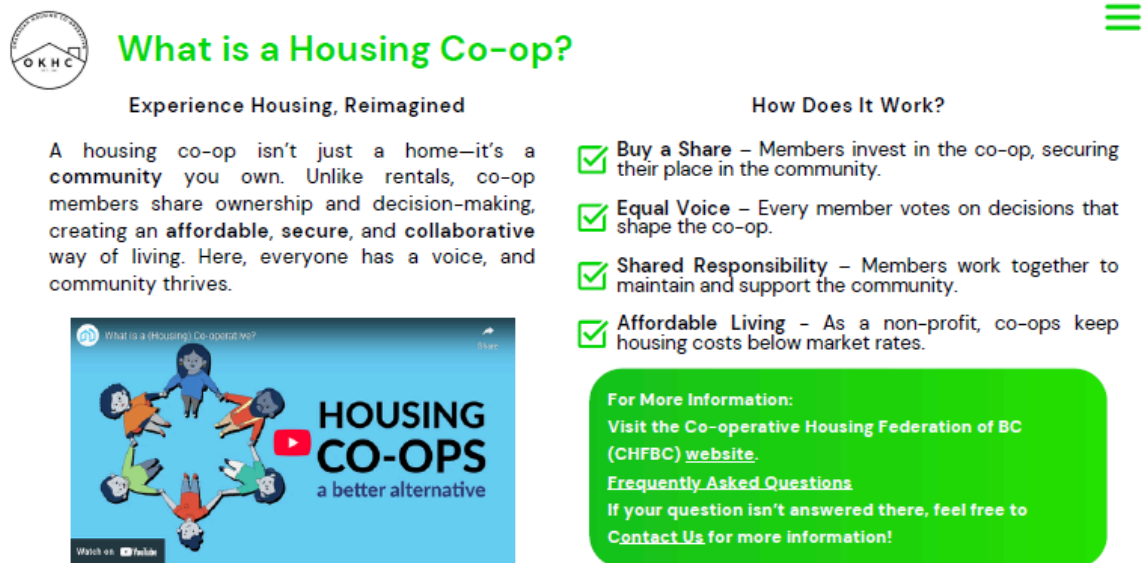


Figure A.14 - Website Mock-up: About OKHC



Figure A.15 - Website Mock-up: Testimonials

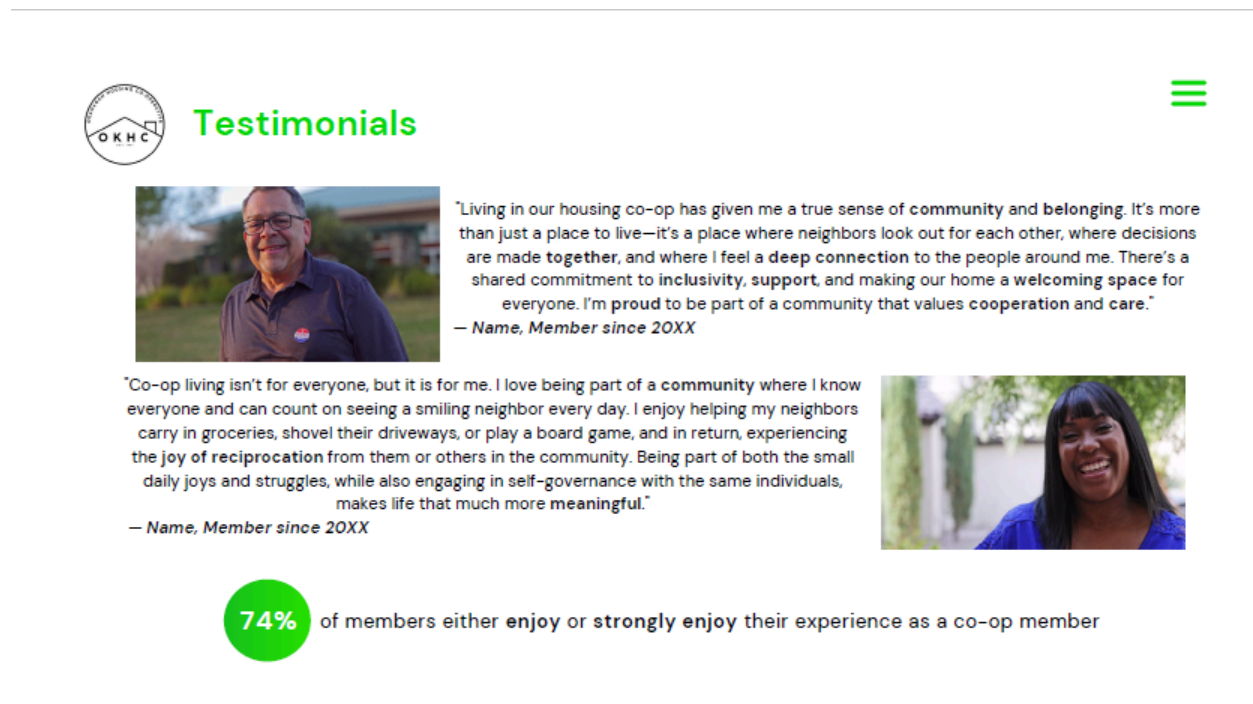


Figure A.16 - Website Mock-up: How to Apply?

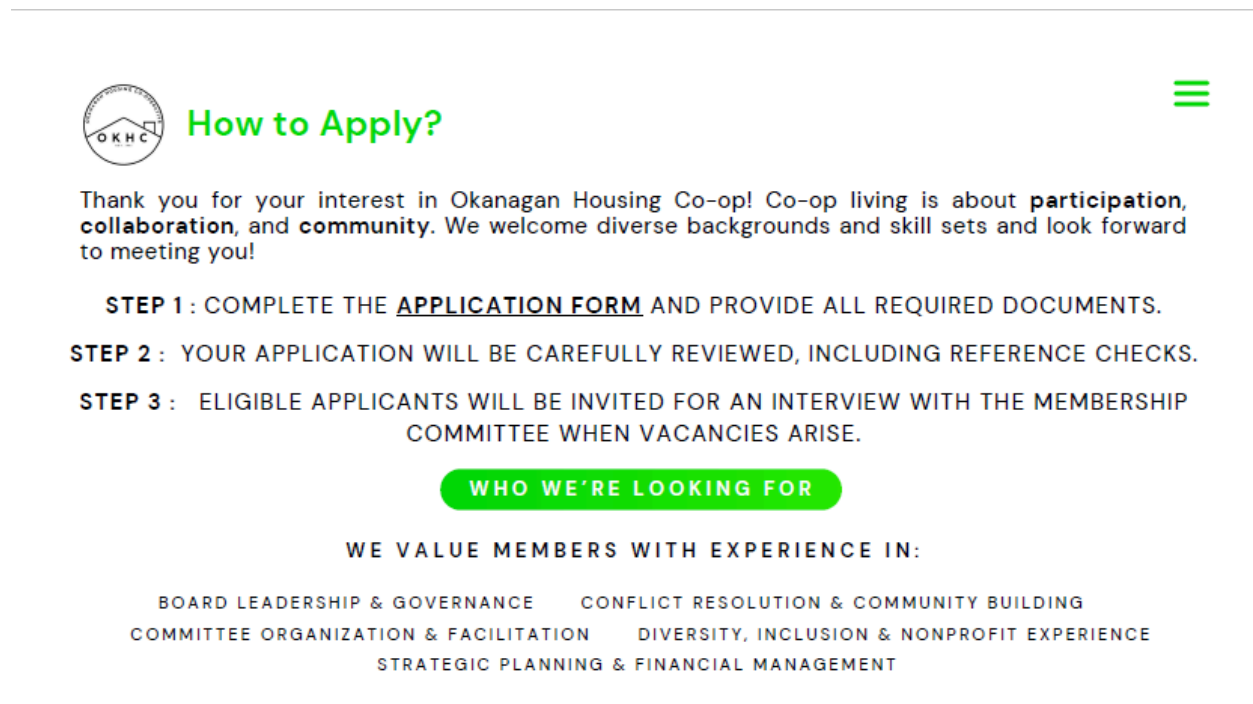


Figure A.17 - Website Mock-up: Gallery

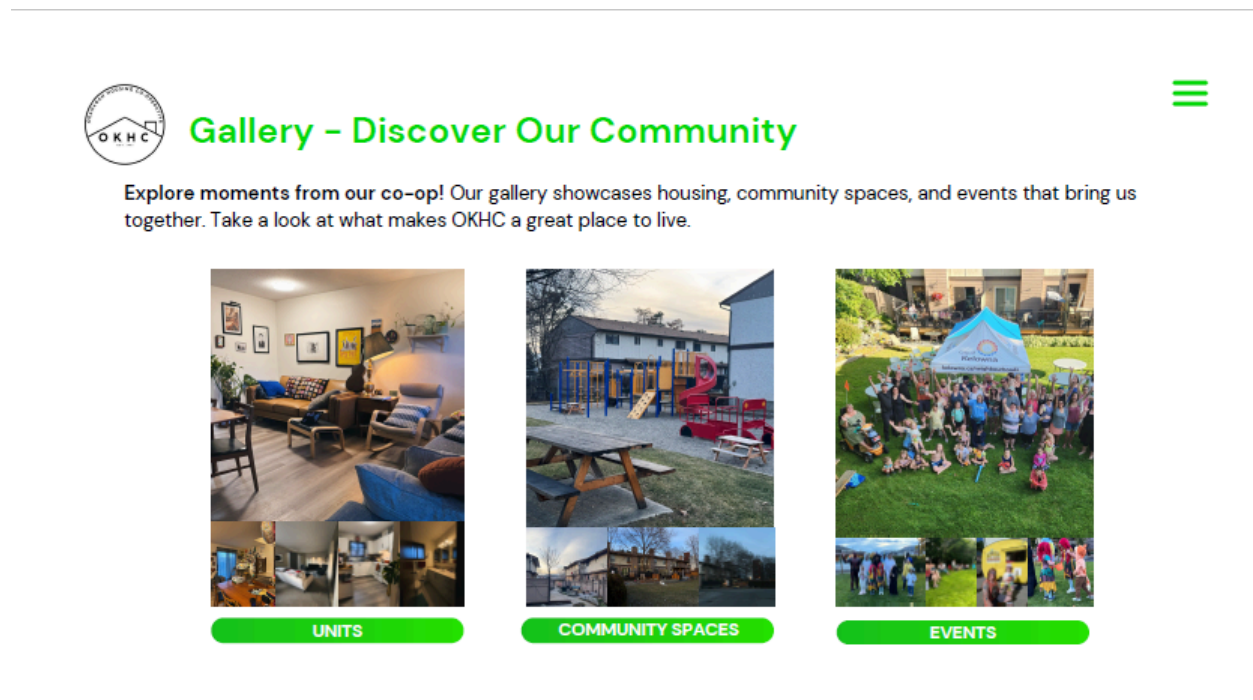


Figure A.18 - Website Mock-up: Contact Us

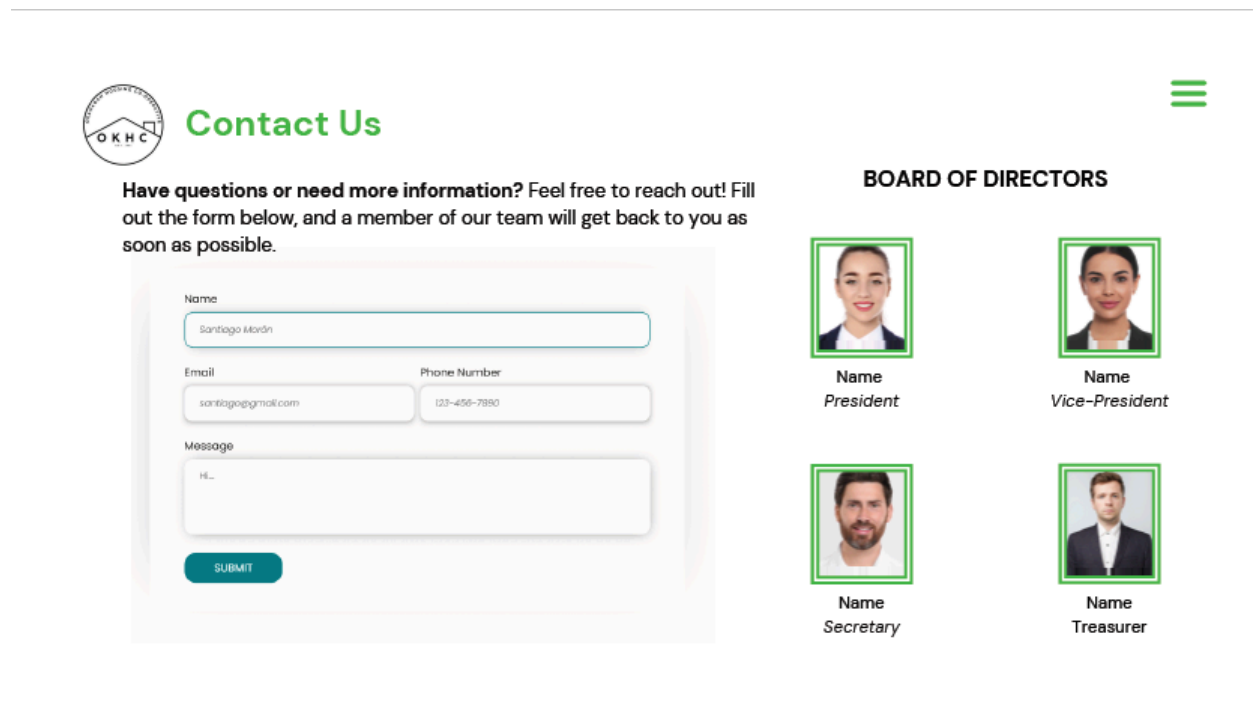


Figure A.19 - Website Mock-up: FAQs

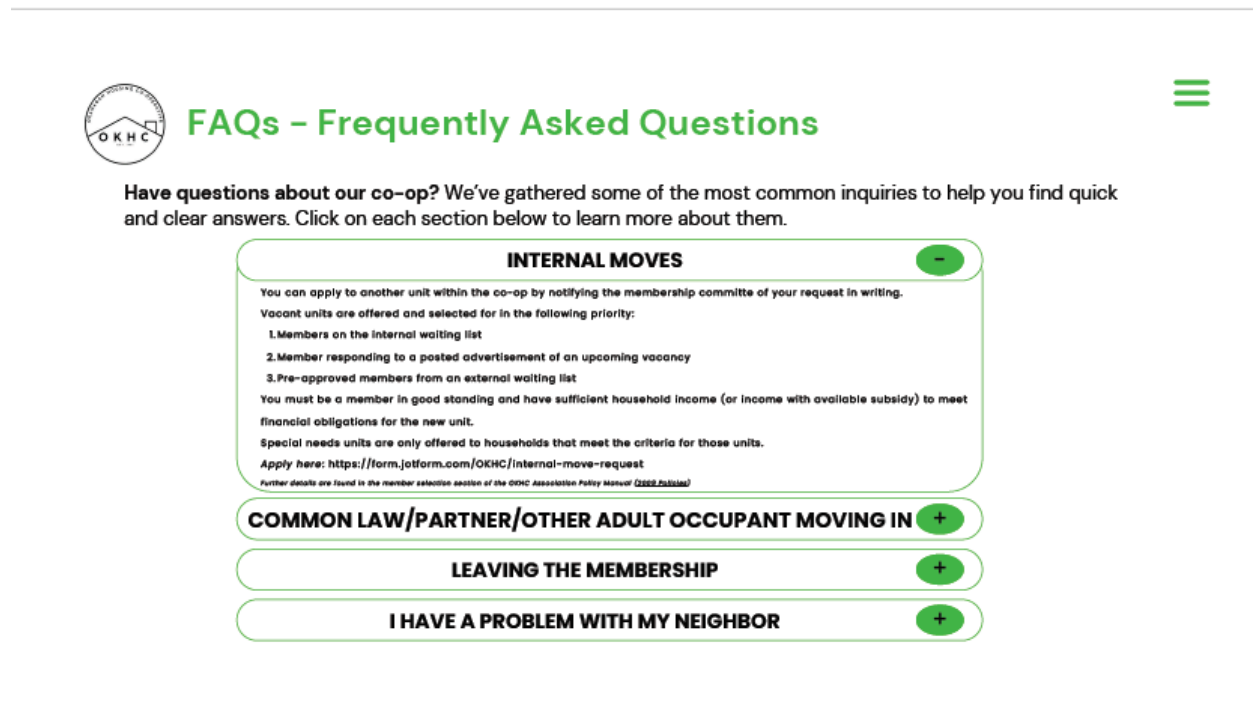


Figure A.20 - Website Mock-up: Condo Control

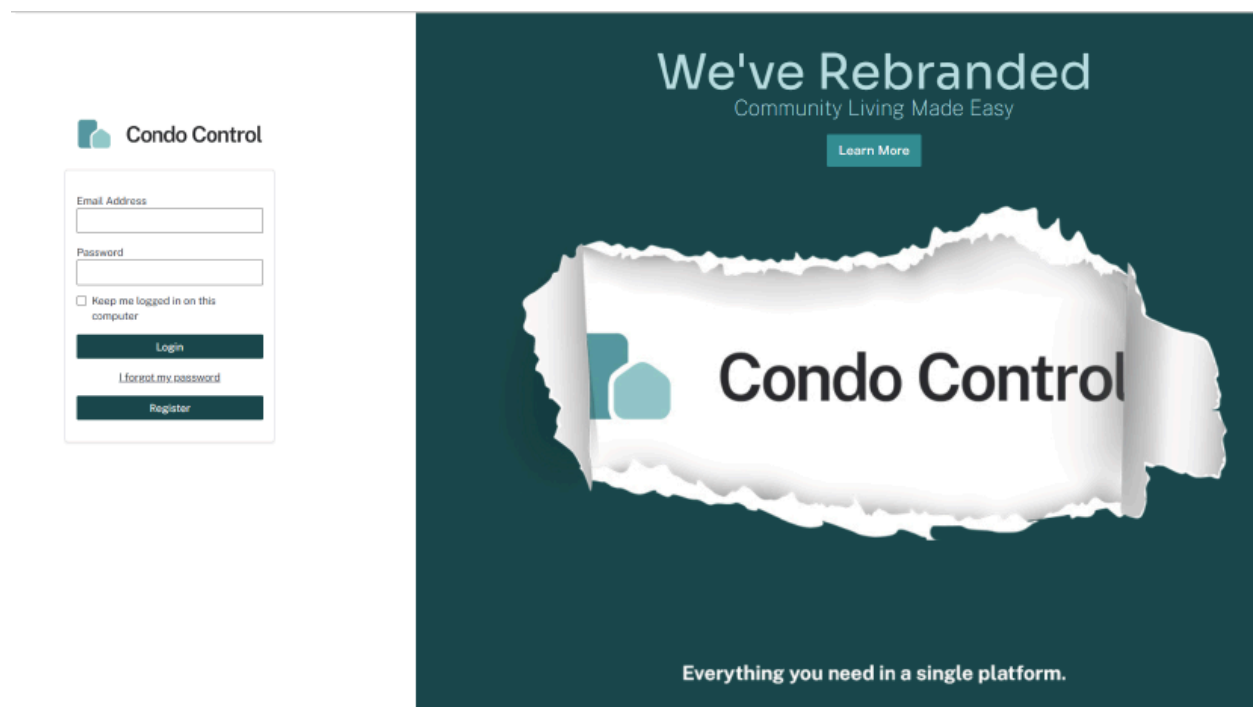


Figure A.21 - Fact Sheet Mock-up



To:

Date , 2025

[Recipient's Name], [Recipient's Title]
123 Anywhere St., Any City
[Your Name], [Your Position, if applicable], [Your Contact Information]
Okanagan Housing Co-op (OKHC)

Subject: Addressing the Housing Crisis – The Role of Co-operative Housing and the Missing Middle

Dear [Recipient's Name],

As the Okanagan Housing Co-op (OKHC), we are reaching out to highlight the **urgent need** for increased support for co-operative housing as a sustainable, community-driven solution to the housing crisis—particularly for the **"missing middle"**: Individuals and households that exceed the income threshold for social housing yet find it challenging to afford market-rate homes.

Co-operative housing provides these households with security of tenure, affordability, and a voice in decision-making—fostering strong, self-governed communities built on collaboration and shared responsibility. Expanding support for co-ops can play a crucial role in addressing the growing housing affordability gap.

A Call for Government Action

We urge your office to consider policies that promote and expand co-operative housing, including:

- **Financial Support & Incentives:** Increased funding, grants, or low-interest loans to help co-ops develop and maintain housing units.
- **Zoning & Land Use Policies:** Reforms to encourage co-op housing development, such as allocating land specifically for non-profit housing initiatives.
- **Public Awareness & Collaboration:** Greater recognition and integration of co-ops within municipal and provincial housing strategies.

We appreciate your time in considering the vital role of co-operative housing in addressing the housing crisis. We welcome the opportunity to discuss how OKHC can collaborate with you to ensure inclusive and sustainable housing solutions for our community.

We look forward to hearing from you!

Sincerely,



Norah Bowman
Secretary - OKHC



Visit our Website!

 123-456-7890

 secretary@okhc.ca

Figure A.22 - Local Representatives for OKHC to contacts

City of Kelowna + West Kelowna city council members

- **Community Planning** - planninginfo@kelowna.ca
- **Mayor of Kelowna** - Tom Dyas mayorandcouncil@kelowna.ca
- **Property Management**: PropertyManagement@kelowna.ca
- **Mayor of West Kelowna**: Gord Milsom mayorandcouncil@westkelownacity.ca
- **Mayor of Peachland**: Patrick Van Minsel MayorVanMinsel@peachland.ca
- **Mayor of Lake Country**: Blaire Ireland mayorandcouncil@lakecountry.bc.ca

Local MLAs:

- **Kelowna**: Kristina Loewen kristina.loewen@conservativebc.ca
- **Kelowna-Mission**: Gavin Dew gavin.dew@conservativebc.ca
- **Kelowna-Lake Country- Coldstream**: Tara Armstrong
tara.armstrong@conservativebc.ca
- **West Kelowna/ Peachland**: Macklin McCall macklin.mccall@conservativebc.ca

Regional District of Central Okanagan: Helps facilitate all business investments and is available to assist with any issues quickly. Have coordinated regional approaches and developed regional growth strategies (RGS)

- **Central Okanagan Economic Development Commission (COEDC) :**
 - [Email link](#)
- **Planning services RDCO/Official community plans:**
 - [Email link](#)
- **Regional growth strategies for local governments**
 - [Email link](#)

Figure A.23 - Local Registration Form

Kelowna Farmers' & Crafters' Market Society Non-Profit Application: 2023

PLEASE PRINT CLEARLY

Contact Person: _____ Date requesting: _____

Non-Profit Name: _____

Mailing Address: _____

City _____ Postal Code: _____

Non-Profit Society Number: _____ Business Phone _____

Email Address: _____

- The KFCMS will allow a certified non-profit organization a free stall on a Wednesday Market Day, space permitting, by pre-registration with the Market Manager.
- For a Saturday stall, the Market Coordinator will determine if a stall would be available. There is no guarantee for a Saturday Market to setup during the months of June through August
- Non-profit organizations may not sell product at the market. Information items, brochures, videos, and demonstrations to promote the organization is acceptable, subject to approval of the Market Manager.
- Collecting donations will need the approval of the Market Manager.
- Non-profits are responsible for supplying their own tables and tents.
- Representatives of the non-profit must be at the market by 6:45 am on days they have pre-registered with the Market Manager.
- Vehicles must be parked off site once unloading is complete.
- The end of the market is sounded by the ringing of a bell at 1:00pm, please do not pack up your stall before this time.
- At the end of the market day, there is to be no driving in or out of the market, nor moving vehicles inside the market (including trailers) before 1:15pm. At that time, please enter and exit the market as per the directional map.

I have read and understand the Rules of Operations 2023 of the Kelowna Farmers' and Crafters' Market and agree to comply with them.

The above information is certified to be accurate, and if found to be otherwise, I agree to accept disciplinary measures as decided by the Kelowna Farmers' and Crafters' Market Society Board of Directors, including expulsion from the market without recourse.

Print Name

Sign Name

Date

Figure A.24 - Print Marketing Material: Business Card Front



Figure A.25 - Print Marketing Material: Business Card Back

NB

Norah Bowman

SECRETARY

+123-456-7890

205 Nickel Rd, Kelowna, BC V1X 4E5

secretary@okhc.ca



Visit our Website!

Figure A.26 - Print Marketing Material: Flyer Front



Figure A.27 - Print Marketing Material: Flyer Back

YOUR GUIDE TO CO-OP LIVING

WHAT IS A HOUSING CO-OP?

A housing cooperative is an alternative non profit form of housing where residents collectively own and manage the property. Within a housing co-op each and every member share the responsibilities, costs, and voting decisions. Co-ops provide sustainable and affordable housing to likeminded community driven people.

WHO ARE WE?

Okanagan Housing Co-op is a member-driven community dedicated to providing affordable, secure, and sustainable housing in the Okanagan region. As a cooperative, we are more than just a place to live—we are a community where members actively participate in decision-making and the upkeep of our shared spaces. Our goal is to create a supportive and inclusive environment where residents have a real voice in their housing while enjoying the benefits of cost-effective, high-quality living. Together, we build a stronger, more connected community for today and future generations.

HOW TO JOIN

Becoming a member of Okanagan Housing Co-op starts with ensuring our values align. We are a community-driven cooperative that values affordability, sustainability, and active participation. If you share these principles and are interested in co-op living, we encourage you to apply! To start the process, visit our website, where you'll find detailed information about our co-op, membership requirements, and the application form. Once submitted, our team will review your application, and if there's a good fit, we'll guide you through the next steps, including an interview and orientation.

Join us in building a strong, engaged community—visit our website to apply today!



Visit our Website!



Figure A.28 - Print Marketing Material: Banner



Figure A.29 - Print Marketing Material: Price Breakdown

Business Cards - B&W Double-sided, please refer 4/1

Business Cards

Price includes output	120lb McCoy Silk Coated Cover				
	100	250	500	1000	Add'l M
4/0	\$44.00	\$58.75	\$77.50	\$105.00	\$84.00
4/1	\$46.50	\$62.00	\$82.50	\$112.00	\$84.00
4/4	\$49.00	\$67.50	\$92.50	\$130.00	\$84.00

Flyer - Color Double-sided, please refer 4/4

Flyers 8.5"x11" (no fold) ** Custom Quote / outsource on Larger quantities

Price includes output	Flyers 8.5x11 (100# Text) – Printed Full bleed on 12x18				
	100	150	250	500	1000**
4/4	\$112.00	\$142.80	\$153.16	\$252.00	\$409

Large Format Sign

* The one with a metal stand is "Retractable Banner"! 33"x80" (approximately 83.82 cm x 203.2 cm)

RETRACTABLE BANNER	Regular	Premium
33x80 78"view	(spicers)	(signworld)
Cassette and print	274	318
Print only	122.10	122.10
Cassette only	109	192

Figure A.30 - KPIs for Local Events

Some of the key performance indicators for this initiative can be found below:

- OKHC attending 1-2 events per month
- Speaking to a minimum of 10 local community members per visit
- New prospects established (1-3 per quarter)
- Attend 1 conference per year

Appendix B

Figure B.1 - Timeline breakdown for Marketing plan implementation with corresponding hours on a monthly basis

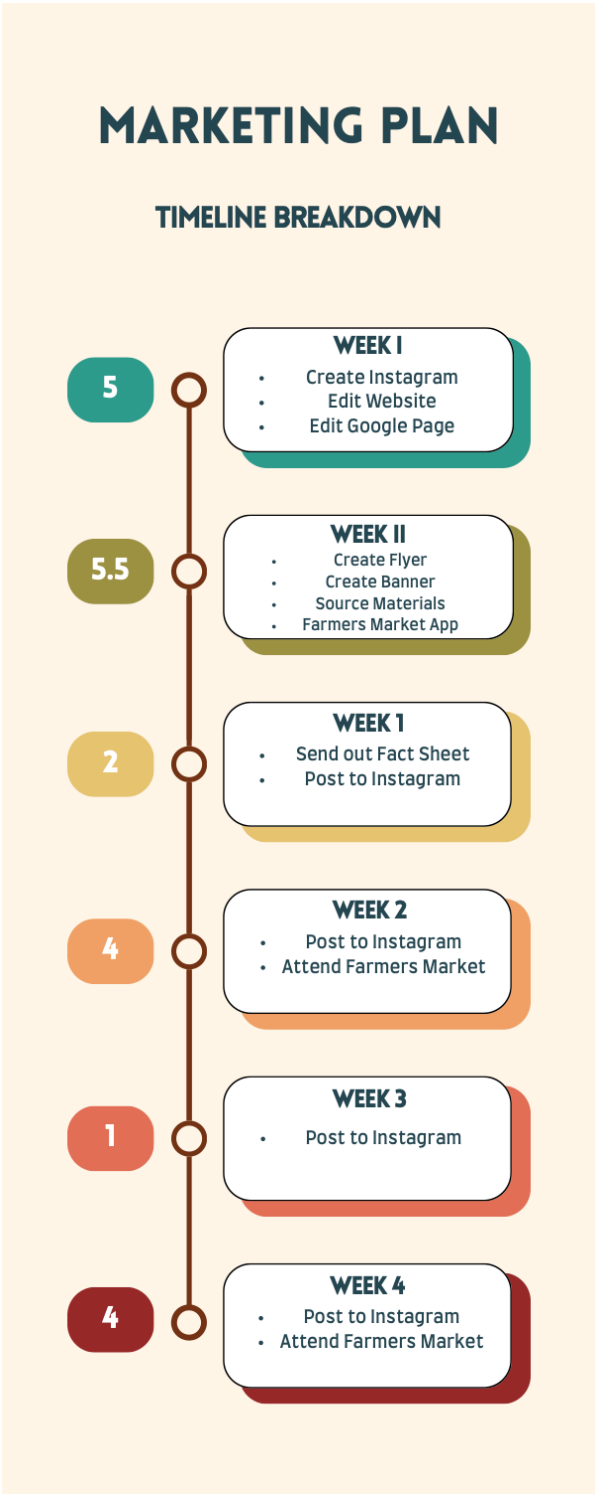


Figure B.2 - Individual task hourly breakdown.

OKHC Action Plan Tasks	Hours
Create Instagram	1
Rework Website	3
Update Google Page	1
Create Flyer	2
Create Banner	2
Source Vendor for Marketing Materials	1
Apply for Farmers Market	0.5
Post to Instagram	1
Send out Fact Sheet	1
Attend Farmers Market	3
Update Marketing Materials	1

Figure B.3 - Annual total cost for marketing campaigns

TOTAL COST BREAKDOWN

LOW-END	MODERATE	HIGH-END
• 250 business cards • 250 flyers • 1 banner	• 500 business cards • 500 flyers • 1 banner	• 500 business cards • 1000 flyers • 2 banner
• Organic Ads • No Conference Attendance	• 2 paid ads per quarter • Conference Attendance one day (\$550)	• 2 paid ads per month • 3 Day Conference Attendance (\$1150)
<u>Total</u> \$515	<u>Total</u> \$1650	<u>Total</u> \$2550

Figure B.4 Gantt Chart

